Sara Rabino

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Last updated: October 15, 2026

Education

2021–Now **PhD in Economics**, *University of Zürich*
Advisors: Ana Costa-Ramón, Roberto A. Weber

2025–2026 **Visiting Fellow**, *Harvard University*
Host: Katherine B. Coffman

2018–2021 **MSc in Economic and Social Sciences**, *Bocconi University*
Thesis Supervisor: Jérôme Adda, Final Grade: 110/110 cum laude

2015–2018 **BSc in Economic and Social Sciences**, *Bocconi University*
Thesis Supervisor: Tommaso Monacelli, Final Grade: 110/110 cum laude

2018 **Exchange Program**, *University College London*

Research Interests

Behavioral Economics, Experimental Economics, Labor Economics

Job Market Paper

Making a Difference? The Role of Social Impact in College Major Choice
(with Ana Brás-Monteiro and Samantha Stelnicki)

Work is not only a means of earning a living, it can also be a source of meaning through the contribution people feel they make to society. Because the choice of academic major largely shapes future career paths, we ask: do students hold accurate perceptions of how fulfilling different fields are in terms of social impact, and how do these perceptions shape major choices? We address these questions through a survey experiment at a large U.S. public university. We find that students substantially underestimate how satisfied previous graduates report being with their contribution, with significant heterogeneity in the extent of underestimation by field. These beliefs are consistent with stereotyping: students believe that graduates in fields such as Health and Social Sciences are much more likely to be satisfied with their contribution than graduates in Physics & Mathematics or Computer Science, while nationally representative data on college graduates shows the gap is much smaller. We show that randomly providing information on previous graduates' experiences of impact across all fields significantly shifts students' perceptions, with revisions proportional to their initial misperceptions. These revised beliefs lead students who value social contribution to recommend a broader set of majors to like-minded peers. We see more limited effects on students' intentions and class enrollment, with significant changes in intentions only among women, who value social impact most and shift toward fields whose social impact they had underestimated.

Work in Progress

Is Social Learning Gendered? with Kobbina Awuah, Stine Helmke, Rafael Hernández-Pachón, Urša Krenk, Daniela Santos Cárdenas and David Yanagizawa-Drott

How Men and Women Want to Do (and Look) Good: Effective Altruism vs Warm Glow

The Effect of Infidelity on Household Resource Allocation in Tanzania with Stine Helmke

Teaching

2024 **Lecturer**, *University of Zürich*
The Economics of Gender Norms (BA)

2023–2024 **Teaching Assistant**, *University of Zürich*
Econometrics for Research Students, Part II (PhD)

2023–Now **Thesis Supervision**, *University of Zürich*
Students: Oliver Schwertfeger (2024), Elto Nathanaël Wolde (2024), Zhao Meng (2023), Hannah Talary (2023)

2016–2020 **Teaching Assistant**, *Bocconi University*
Computer Science (BA)

Work Experience

2023 **Research Assistant**, *University of Zürich*
For David Yanagizawa-Drott and Anne Ardila Brenøe

2020–2021 **Research Assistant**, *IGIER, Bocconi University*
For Thomas Le Barbanchon and Jérôme Adda

2020 **Research Assistant**, *Bocconi University*
For Tommaso Nannicini

Grants

2025 UZH Candoc Grant (CHF 61,661)

2025 URPP Research Grant (CHF 7,011)

Scholarships & Awards

2024 URPP Senior PhD Scholarship

2023 URPP Early-stage PhD Scholarship

2018 Bocconi Graduate Merit Award, full-waiver scholarship

Presentations

2026 ACME Seminar (Harvard Graduate School of Education); EALE (Universitat de Barcelona); LEER (KU Leuven); PhD Workshop in Labor and Behavioral Economics (CEBI, University of Copenhagen); IWAEE (Catanzaro)

2025 EER Summer School in Behavioral and Experimental Economics (LUISS, Rome); MIT Behavioral Student Lunch

2024 Economics of Breastfeeding (Engelberg)

Public Service

2027 **Organizer**, *PhD Workshop in Labor and Behavioral Economics*, University of Zürich

2024 **Organizer**, *UZH Doctoral Labor Seminar*, University of Zürich

2019–2022 **Senior Fellow**, *Tortuga Think Tank*

Computer Skills

Office, Stata, Python, MatLab: good

RStudio, Eviews: beginner

Languages

Italian Mothertongue

English Fluent

French Intermediate

German Basic

References

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